

State Review Learnings:

University of Arkansas – Pine Bluff

Alternative Route

On-Site Review: November 5–6, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, “Candidate Recruitment and Completion,” is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, “Preparing Candidates Effectively,” criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, “Supporting Workforce Needs,” are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two
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University of Arkansas - Pine Bluff

Alternative Route

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: Pursue initiatives to recruit candidates in subject shortage areas. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a</i>)		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

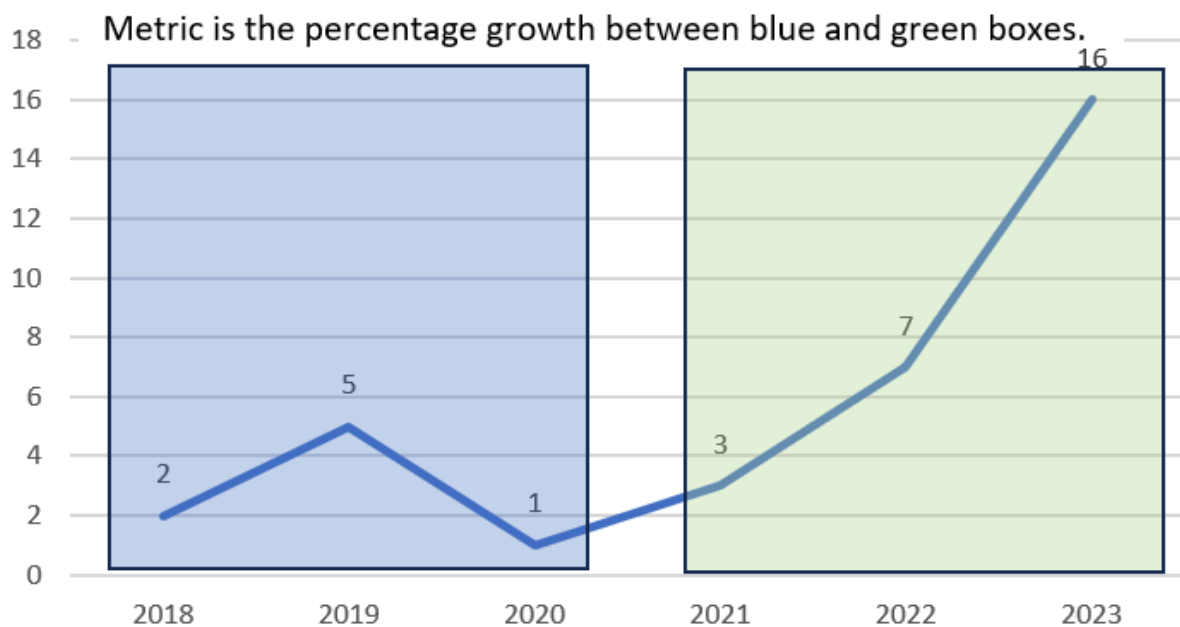
Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The UAPB Alternative Annual Plan demonstrates the intentional alignment of coursework and licensure preparation to ensure candidate success.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	225%	EXCEEDS

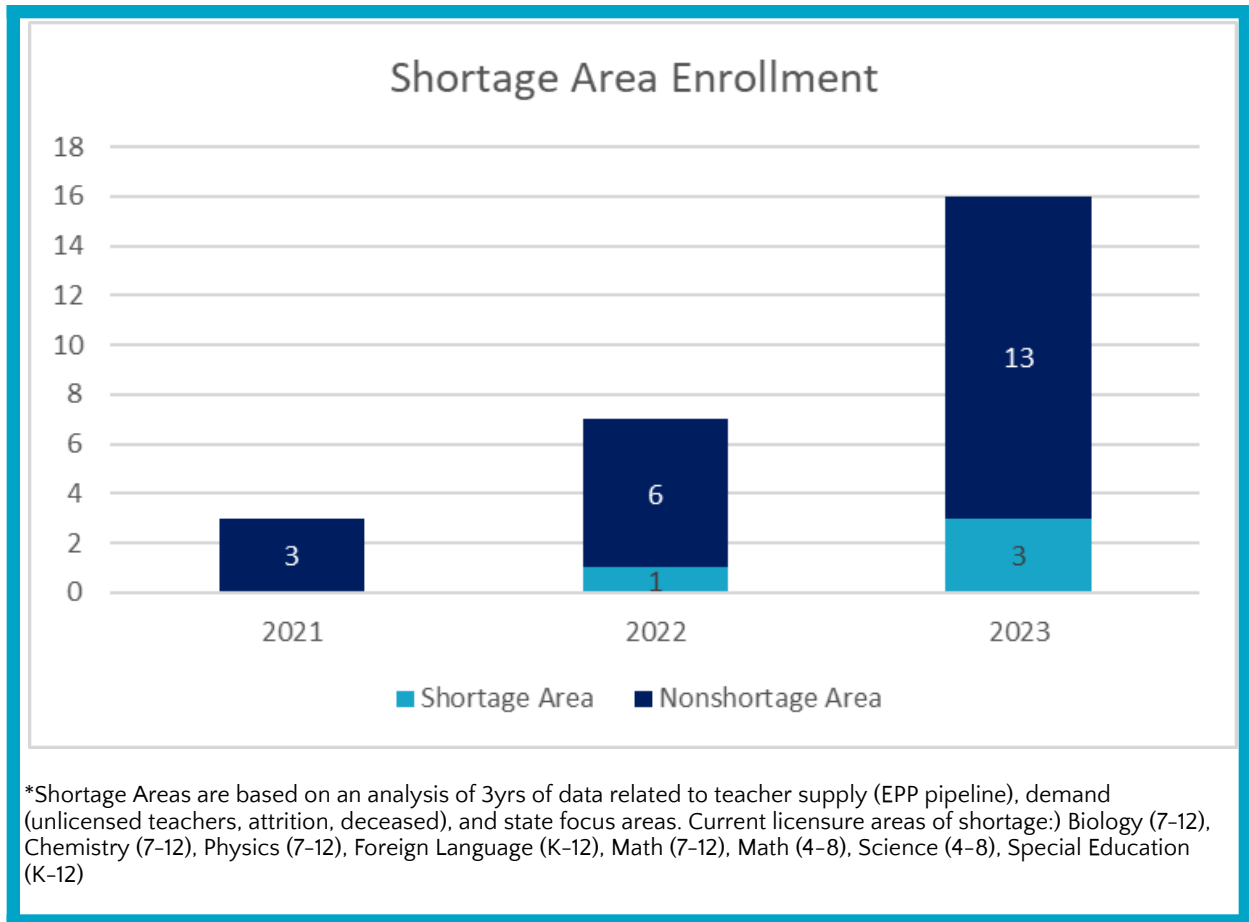
Enrollment



*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

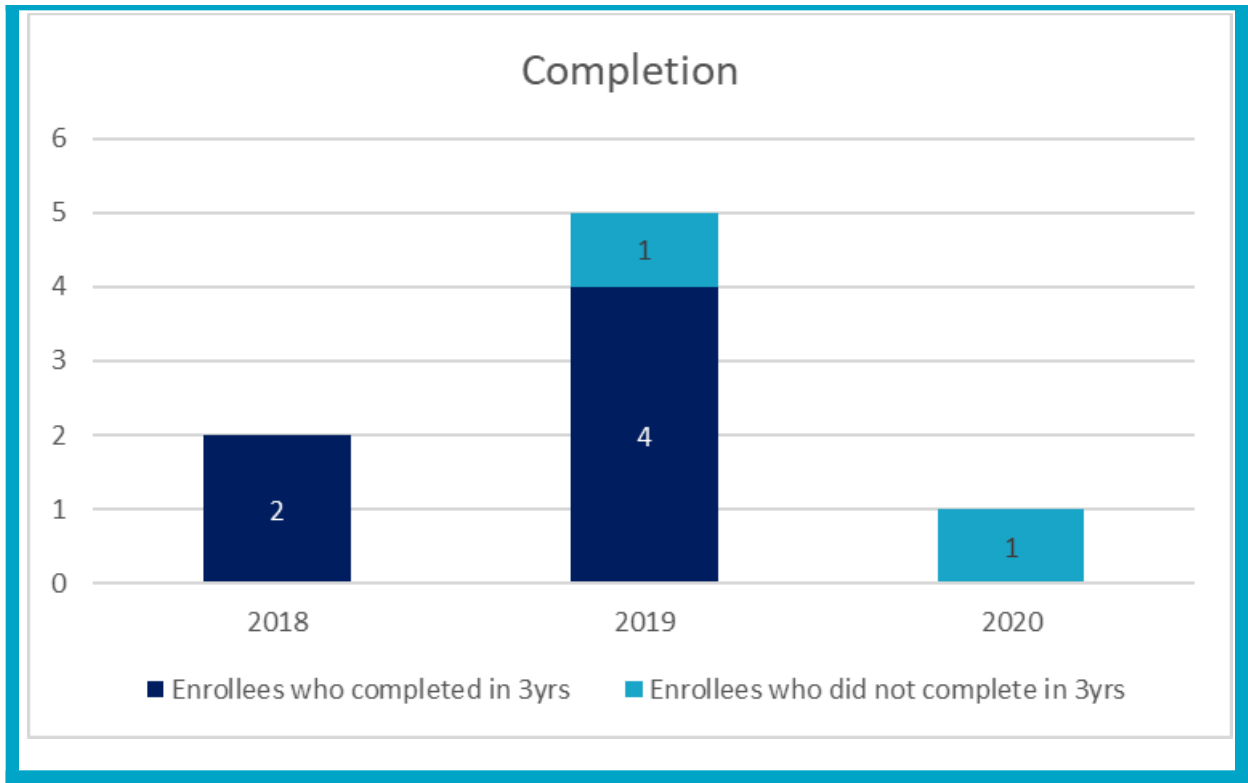
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need

Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	15%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	75%	MEETS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	APPROACHING	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
University of Arkansas – Pine Bluff’s MAT program provides candidates with strong coursework that is aligned with clinical experiences. The course instructors and clinical supervisors are recognized as supportive and effective in preparing candidates for the classroom. The MAT paid residency program is a highlight for candidates and school partners. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • Create or revise an evaluation process to collect feedback from candidates and clinical supervisors regarding the effectiveness and support from the experienced mentor teacher (<i>Focus Area 2.2b Metric 1</i>) • Ensure all candidates receive consistent feedback from clinical supervisors and experienced mentor teachers that is aligned to the ATR, includes evidence of student learning, and actionable feedback (<i>Focus Area 2.2b Metric 4</i>) • Document a clear and intentional process to fully support teacher candidates individually who may fall behind in their coursework or clinical experience, so that it allows EPP staff and the teacher candidate to monitor their progress to get back on track actively (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.3a Metric 2, 2.3b Metric 4</i>)		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS Coursework incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including TESS, HQIM, and aligning lessons with standards. HQIM was mentioned in the Teaching Reading and Writing Across Curriculum (GEDU5329) syllabus, and alignment with standards was listed in the Clinical Internship I and II (GEDU5361 and GEDU5362) syllabus. Three candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) stated the coursework provided them with multiple opportunities to engage with high-quality instructional materials (HQIMs), supporting the development of effective lesson plans and instructional strategies aligned with state standards. HQIMs are incorporated through assignments such as video analysis, where candidates select a video from the HQIM library and evaluate its use of best practices in content instruction. The Foundations of Teaching modules guide candidates in understanding curriculum design and constructing meaningful lesson plan questions, ensuring alignment with both state standards and evidence-based practices. Course instructors (n=5) gave specific examples of utilizing best practices. One example is that candidates “develop a mini lesson plan that has to incorporate HQIM and knowledge of the HQIM used by the school districts in

which the candidates are teachers of record.” Candidates are first taught the meaning of HQIM and how to use Ed Reports to look at approved HQIM in the state.

Reviewers noted evidence of best practices in course observations. In Teaching Reading and Writing Across Curriculum (GEDU5329), the coursework includes Scarborough’s Reading Rope, cognitive neuroscience, and the essential elements of reading through evidence-based practices. The course aligns with ATS, TESS, ISTE standards, Praxis competencies, and Foundations of Reading. Candidates are required to complete the Science of Reading training on AR IDEAS.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
APPROACHING

Coursework somewhat familiarizes candidates with the Arkansas K-12 Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area, as seen in the lesson planning activities in the course syllabi. However, reviewers did not see evidence of unpacking standards or aligning standards across grade bands in the documentation.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) and Course Instructors (n=5) provided examples of the use of Arkansas K-12 Standards in coursework through writing objectives, assessments, unpacking standards, and lesson plans. Candidates discussed how they engage with lessons such as ELA activities on adverbs, building on foundational knowledge of nouns and verbs, while videos and assignments guide them in identifying what to teach students who are struggling. Candidates talked about vertical alignment, with one participant providing the example of “connecting K-1 literacy foundations to writing and encoding skills in upper grades, guided by frameworks like Scarborough’s Reading Rope and Writing Rope.”

Reviewers did not see evidence of alignment to standards or vertical integration in any of the three course observations, noting “while coursework intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 standards, there was no evidence of integrating standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area” and in another observation, “Module 3 did provide information on lesson planning but no assignment to demonstrate knowledge of K-12 standards or vertical alignment.”

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates’ coursework supports their development as a teacher
MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
MEETS

Courses are sequenced across the MAT program to build off previous coursework and to build a strong pedagogical foundation. A progression of rigor is noted in the course offerings, with candidates beginning with classroom management, then moving into assessment and curriculum. The MAT coursework is based on the TESS/Danielson teaching framework.

A participant in the Coursework focus group (n=4) shared, “I take everything I’ve learned; it is all building on itself.” All five participants in the Course Instructor focus group agree that courses are intentionally sequenced and built in rigor. They shared multiple times how the program has been transformed to ensure the sequence, the rigor, and pedagogical skills are built on previous coursework, and allow candidates to progress as educators.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework
MEETS

A review of the MAT program syllabi showed that most align with the Arkansas Teaching Standards, focusing on the targeted standards outlined in the course objectives and assignments. Candidates are observed and evaluated using the ATR, ensuring that candidates meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area.

Course Instructors confirmed this in the focus group (n=5), saying “candidates can see those connections in every course because they’re preparing to teach students in real classrooms, and it’s important that they understand how the standards guide their practice from the very beginning.” All the faculty agreed that using the backward design approach when planning courses was important, starting with the outcomes. “What we want our candidates to know and be able to do, and then we determine how to get them there. This means aligning course objectives, activities, and assessments directly with the Arkansas Teaching Standards.” “For example, if the outcome focuses on creating an

effective learning environment, the course includes readings, discussions, and assignments that help candidates build those specific skills.”

Reviewers saw evidence of alignment to standards in two of the three observations. In Curriculum Development (GEDU 5324), reviewers noted, “The instructor demonstrates effective planning through backward design and differentiation strategies. Instructional delivery includes examples, scaffolding, and technology integration. InTASC standards were introduced early in the semester.” In Reading and Writing Across Curriculum (GEDU5360), “The alignment is evident in the syllabus and throughout the coursework and assignments specifically for standards one through eight.”

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is aligned to clinical experience, as many candidates are teachers of record. The curriculum map indicates the alignment of coursework with clinical experience, and syllabi include required observation and clinical experience hours. Candidates reflect on the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors through POP Cycles and informal Walk Through observations, as well as through course assignments and discussions.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) gave examples of alignment, saying “we submit lesson plans and receive feedback from instructors, focusing on how to target individual student needs and increase engagement, emphasizing the importance of moving from a “good lesson” to a “great lesson.” One candidate teacher noted that strategies they learned in coursework (movable alphabets, Read-Build-Write, and color-coding word parts) helped them recognize missed decoding and encoding skills in students. Course Instructors reiterated this saying, “because candidates are already in the schools, the assignments have been created to relate to their classroom,” and “every assignment relates back to their school.” Several courses are “scenario-based,” helping candidates connect coursework to real classroom challenges. In the SEL lesson, for example, candidates “get to pick the brain of the mentor” and focus on “relationship building, especially with SEL and soft skills.” School partners and completers have affirmed that “this is what we need teachers to be doing,” showing strong alignment between coursework and the expectations of the field.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy through their professional development and teaching experiences. All instructors have completed ATR training, and four of the six have completed HQIM or Cognitive Coaching training.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) report that instructors provide ample resources, both online and through direct communication, and are responsive to questions via phone or text, ensuring ongoing support. For example, instructors provide targeted feedback on lesson planning, POP cycles, and formative assessments, helping candidates understand their mistakes, refine strategies, and implement best practices in their classrooms.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Course instructors show a proven history of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support to candidates. Documentation provided included Student Evaluations and Mid-Term Reflection responses. Evaluation and responses are mostly positive towards the course instructors, with respondents agreeing that their course instructors are well prepared and clearly explain concepts.

All candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) agreed their instructors are responsive, help explain unclear assignments, review (our) work samples, and help “translate coursework into lessons my students can understand.” Candidates report that even in an online format, instructors remain accessible and supportive, ensuring they have the tools and understanding needed to implement standards-aligned, effective instruction.

Reviewers saw evidence of effective instructors in course observations, stating, “The course instructor demonstrates a strong facilitation of the course through weekly modules, announcements, videos, discussions, and feedback to support candidate growth as teachers.”

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. MAT candidates complete targeted POP cycles in the behavioral management and curriculum development courses during year 1 before completing the one-year supervised residency in year 2 as teachers of record. According to the "UAPB One-Year Residency Handbook," the clinical internship requires an orientation meeting at the beginning of each semester, two informal evaluations by the EMT/principal each semester, two informal evaluations by the clinical supervisor, and two formal POP cycles by the clinical supervisor each semester. The Handbook contains a continuum of co-teaching models with suggested sequences of how those models can be used for gradual release of responsibility. According to the "UAPB 2025 Official Mentor Handbook," MAT candidates must also complete two observations of other teachers in their building.

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) described a clear sequence of clinical experiences that included coursework in classroom management, followed by a fall internship as a teacher of record. The Clinical Supervisor (n=1) provided additional evidence saying the MAT program has undergone a complete restructuring from 36 to 30 credit hours, with a clear and intentional design that integrates clinical experiences throughout the two-year program. Candidates begin with foundational coursework and progress toward full teaching responsibilities during their internship phase. All candidates serve as teachers of record during their clinical internship, which meets the 15-week minimum requirement and provides authentic classroom experience.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. As part of Behavioral Management (GEDU5363), candidates work with an individual student in their classroom to develop a functional behavior assessment and behavior intervention plan based on that student's unique needs. During weeks 9-12 of the clinical internship, candidates are working with learners with a variety of needs, including differentiation, UDL, ELLs, and SEL.

Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=2) reported exposure to multiple grade levels and student needs. One candidate shared, "I currently teach 8th grade and observed 6th grade before I started my internship," demonstrating varied classroom environments. Others referenced working with students with varied learning needs, with one saying, "I have worked with students with IEPs and 504s and to learn from my mentor teacher and to differentiate and teach via lesson planning and feel incorporated in the classroom." The Clinical Supervisor (n=1) also shared that candidates complete clinical experiences in schools with varied demographics, ensuring exposure to different student populations and instructional contexts. Focus group participants confirmed that these placements are intentionally selected to provide opportunities to work with a variety of students

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

APPROACHING

Some experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. The "UAPB One-Year Residency Handbook" summarizes the roles and responsibilities of mentors and describes various co-teaching models that can be used for a gradual release of responsibility, the "US PREP POP Cycle Packet" provides mentors with templates and detailed step-by-step instructions for completing POP cycles; and the "UAPB 2025 Official Mentor Handbook" references initial training provided to mentor teachers by the EPP as well as support available to mentors from the UAPB MAT program coordinator. However, no evidence of the mentor training was submitted, nor was any evidence submitted that demonstrated the actual coaching and feedback provided to MAT candidates.

All participants in the Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group (n=4) shared that they have over 20 years of experience and a master's degree. Mentors mentioned they attend many professional development opportunities, including AVID, Marzano, and multiple coaching and mentoring trainings. Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=2) consistently praised their mentor teachers for being hands-on and responsive. One participant described co-teaching and receiving actionable feedback, indicating mentors are equipped to support pedagogical development.

Additional evidence was shared in the Clinical Supervisor focus group (n=1). Mentor training sessions include discussions about candidates who still need to complete licensure exams. While collaboration is described as occurring through meetings and emails, the supervisor noted that documentation of these interactions could be improved and shared more consistently.

Note: By 2026–2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria that aligns with DESE requirements. Requirements for experienced mentor teachers are outlined in the “UAPB One-Year Residency Handbook.” Experienced mentor teachers must also agree to complete cognitive coaching and mentor teacher training prior to serving as a mentor. Overall, the EPP’s MAT mentors have an average of 15 years of teaching experience, 100% have received ATR training, 90% teach in the same district, 66% have completed cognitive coaching training, and 33% have a master/lead designation. The data provided does not indicate the most recent evaluation rating for all mentors.

Participants in the Partnership focus group (n=2) confirmed that the selection of experienced mentor teachers follows a formal process aligned with the criteria outlined in the Mentor Teacher Manual. Mentor teachers are chosen based on the following criteria: A minimum of three years of classroom experience, demonstrated instructional effectiveness, a strong investment in the Pine Bluff community, and positive relationships with colleagues. They shared, “This year presented unique challenges due to the placement of 14 paraprofessionals in the district as interns. However, each intern was thoughtfully paired with a mentor teacher to ensure support and continuity in their clinical experience.”

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practices. The “MAT UAPB Course Instructor/Clinical Supervisor List” lists two clinical supervisors. Both supervisors hold an Ed degree; both have teaching experience and recent training. Documentation included instructor evaluation ratings from three students for the behavioral management course, as well as the MAT Internship Mid-Term Reflection completed by one candidate. While feedback responses were positive, there was no additional evidence to determine the quality of clinical supervisors overall from a majority of MAT candidates.

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) reported that clinical supervisors were accessible and provided timely feedback. One noted, “Our supervisor was very adamant about being available... quick with the feedback in helping us grow.”

In all three coaching observations, reviewers saw evidence of strong coaching. In one observation, reviewers note, “the clinical supervisor asked a number of high-level questions to prompt the candidate’s reflective thinking about the lesson, and she utilized active listening through paraphrasing.” While the clinical supervisor pushed the candidate’s thinking further about content-specific issues at several points, they did not provide the candidate with any clarification that would demonstrate their knowledge of the content and of AR K-12 standards generally. In another observation, reviewers noted, “The clinical supervisor facilitated a reflective coaching session that encouraged the intern to analyze instructional strategies, student engagement, and differentiation. They affirmed strengths, asked probing questions about scaffolding and assessment, and offered actionable feedback (e.g., guiding students to correct answers rather than simply stating they are wrong).”

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

APPROACHING

Candidates sometimes receive high-quality feedback. Submitted evidence demonstrates written feedback given to candidates on their POP preconference questions and after a classroom walkthrough; however, only one example of

each document was provided, so it is unclear how frequently this feedback is provided or if it is building off of previous feedback. In both cases, the written feedback is specific, bite-sized, actionable, and aligned with the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (preconference feedback focuses on Domain 1, whereas walkthrough feedback focuses on Domains 2-3). The walkthrough feedback incorporates evidence of student learning from the observation.

Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=2) gave examples of weekly feedback on classroom management and pacing, and guidance on incorporating background learning. Although written feedback was limited, verbal and assignment-based feedback were consistent and linked to student learning outcomes. The Clinical Supervisor gave a feedback example, saying, "During formal observations, the program uses a POP cycle and a structured form based on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. I collaborate with mentor teachers and candidates to compare feedback and ensure alignment." Experienced Mentor teachers (n=2) shared that they provide daily oral feedback, and provide written feedback aligned to the ATR during their formal observations; however, language aligned with the ATR is not used consistently when giving feedback.

In coaching observations, reviewers saw evidence of strong feedback, but also noted there was a lack of alignment with the ATR. Reviewers stated, "It was unclear if any of the feedback was explicitly building off previous feedback. Although feedback is generally aligned, none of the feedback provided by the clinical supervisor (during the observation) made reference to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric."

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

APPROACHING

Some collaborative processes are in place with districts and schools to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. The EPP engages school and district leaders in shared governance meetings that allow for the review of candidate observation data, discussion of mentor selection criteria and training, norming on common areas of practice, and setting action steps; No evidence was submitted to demonstrate collaboration between clinical supervisors and school administrators outside of the shared governance meetings, nor for any collaboration between clinical supervisors and experienced mentors teachers. The EPP also collaborates with the district and a third-party group (TPI) to provide MAT candidates with individualized test prep support.

Participants in the Partnership focus group (n=2) described a strong and evolving partnership between UAPB and local districts. One district leader highlighted intentional collaboration through governance meetings and planning sessions, noting that district expectations are embedded and crosswalked with the EPP's program. The partnership has become more intentional over time, especially in how residents are placed to support retention. They shared that communication between the EPP and districts is both formal and informal. One district requested streamlined communication through the Office of Recruitment and Retention, which has improved coordination and clarity. Candidates participate in school professional development and are gradually integrated into instructional roles.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. The EPP partners with US PREP to provide initial training and ongoing development to all site coordinators (who serve as clinical supervisors) through their annual two-day in-person convening. The EPP also provides support through monthly meetings with chairs and coordinators that allow for the sharing of program updates, SOE and DESE updates, and action items, as well as annual meetings for progress monitoring of candidates at admission, retention, and exit checkpoints. The Clinical Supervisor shared that they participate in ongoing professional development to strengthen their instructional practices and enhance their ability to support teacher candidates. These opportunities include clinical convenings with US Prep, program coordinator meetings, and targeted trainings on High-Quality Instructional Materials (HQIM), the Science of Reading, Cognitive Coaching, and best pedagogical practices.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

APPROACHING

Candidates are consistently successful in meeting coursework requirements, and the Educator Preparation Provider (EPP) has a system in place to track and support those who are not meeting proficiency standards. The "SOE Graduate Programs spreadsheet (2022–2023)" tracks individual candidate GPA, Praxis completion status, academic standing, and program exit status. Out of 111 candidates, 86 maintained a GPA of 3.0 or higher, resulting in a proficiency rate of 77.48%.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with individualized support plans if their coursework requirements are not on track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. The "MAT Remediation Plan" outlines a structured process for candidates who do not pass the Praxis content exam within the first six credit hours. This includes formal notification, a required remediation meeting with the Program Coordinator and Department Chair, and a co-developed Praxis Success Plan. Candidates actively participate in selecting interventions such as tutoring, study schedules, and diagnostic reviews. Progress is monitored bi-weekly, and extended support options are documented. The "MAT 2024 Annual Report" further supports this metric by describing monthly one-on-one advising, use of the Aviso Early Alert System to flag candidates needing support, and oversight by the Admission, Retention, and Exit Committee (AREC). These systems reflect a commitment to continuous monitoring and adjustment of support strategies.

A sample academic probation letter outlines the criteria for probation and provides recommendations for regaining good standing, including GPA targets and course repetition. The SOE Graduate Programs spreadsheet (2022–2023) shows tracking of GPA, Praxis status, and academic standing, including notes on probation and program exit. Participants in the Course Instructor focus group (n=5) shared that students who are struggling are placed in remediation plans where they meet with faculty via Zoom or in person to establish clear timelines, review requirements such as financial obligations and the six-hour rule, and develop Praxis practice plans. Faculty take a highly personalized approach, reaching out by phone or text when they sense a student is struggling and discussing exactly what steps are needed for success in the course. Beyond academic support, the program demonstrates a holistic approach: the program collaborates with students and their families. Support also extends to engaging school districts and other learning partners to ensure students have the resources and guidance needed to succeed.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Candidates consistently meet clearly defined goals and milestones during their clinical internship, and the Educator Preparation Provider (EPP) systematically tracks and evaluates progress. The "30-Hour Degree Plan" outlines a sequenced curriculum with foundational coursework followed by Clinical Internship I and II in the second year. Advancement to Phase II requires passing the Master of Arts in Teaching Institute course with a grade of B or higher, demonstrating clear academic milestones and readiness expectations. The "MAT Curriculum Map" visually reinforces this progression, identifying Praxis passage and completion of prerequisite coursework as requirements for entering the clinical internship. This structured timeline ensures candidates are on track for licensure and aligns with the rubric's expectations for clarity of milestones.

One participant in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=2) referenced performance assessments and course requirements, saying, "We had to perform and get a B or above in each course before we could move on." The Clinical Supervisor (n=1) said, "Milestones are clearly communicated, and 100% of candidates typically meet them, as they are not admitted to the internship until they have passed their licensure exams."

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

Candidates consistently demonstrate the ability to analyze student data, adjust instruction, and positively impact student learning. For example, in the “Formative Assessment Student Work,” a teacher candidate used a “Quick Quiz” to assess comprehension of main ideas and supporting details. While 80% of students succeeded on multiple-choice items, open-ended responses revealed gaps. The candidate reflected on these results and planned instructional adjustments, including modeling reasoning and using sentence frames to support deeper understanding. In the PBIS Project, candidates conduct a “Functional Behavior Assessment” and implement a “Behavior Intervention Plan” using strategies such as self-monitoring, positive affirmations, and a token economy. In the provided example, progress monitoring showed measurable improvements in student behavior and engagement. The candidate reflected on the effectiveness of the interventions and made adjustments, demonstrating impact on students’ social-emotional growth. Additionally, the “Impact on Student Growth Exit Ticket” shows how the candidate used student performance data to reflect on instructional effectiveness. In the example provided, the candidate identified which students needed additional support and planned differentiated instruction to address those needs, demonstrating a clear link between data analysis and instructional decision-making.

Both candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group described using data walls and assessments to track student progress. One shared, “I saw a lot of my student growth increase from my first semester to my second semester.” The Clinical Supervisor shared that candidates regularly review classroom data to identify which students need additional support and which are ready for enrichment. Instructors guide candidates through this process, helping them monitor and respond to student learning needs. Post-conference discussions reinforce the use of data to evaluate instructional impact.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Candidates consistently demonstrate proficiency in effective teaching skills, as measured by performance on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) and supported by structured feedback and coaching systems. For example, the “End of Internship TESS Spring 2024” spreadsheet shows that all candidates received ratings of “Meeting” or “Exceeding” expectations across Danielson domains, indicating that ≥80% of candidates are scoring “effective” at the end of their clinical internship.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Candidates receive individualized support during their clinical internship, particularly when they are struggling academically or professionally. While documentation showed examples of support, evidence was focused on support during coursework, rather than the clinical internship.

However, in focus groups, reviewers heard evidence of the support candidates received. Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=2) reported receiving individualized support, especially in areas of struggle such as pacing and classroom management. One candidate said, “I received support in areas where I felt that I was lacking,” and another described opportunities to shadow experienced teachers. The Clinical Supervisor confirmed support for candidates, saying, “When candidates struggle, mentor teachers and university supervisors collaborate to develop a support plan tailored to the candidate’s needs—whether academic, personal, or professional.”

Focus group participants also shared how high-performing candidates are recognized, including through an ambassador program, where they present at conferences and serve as program representatives.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

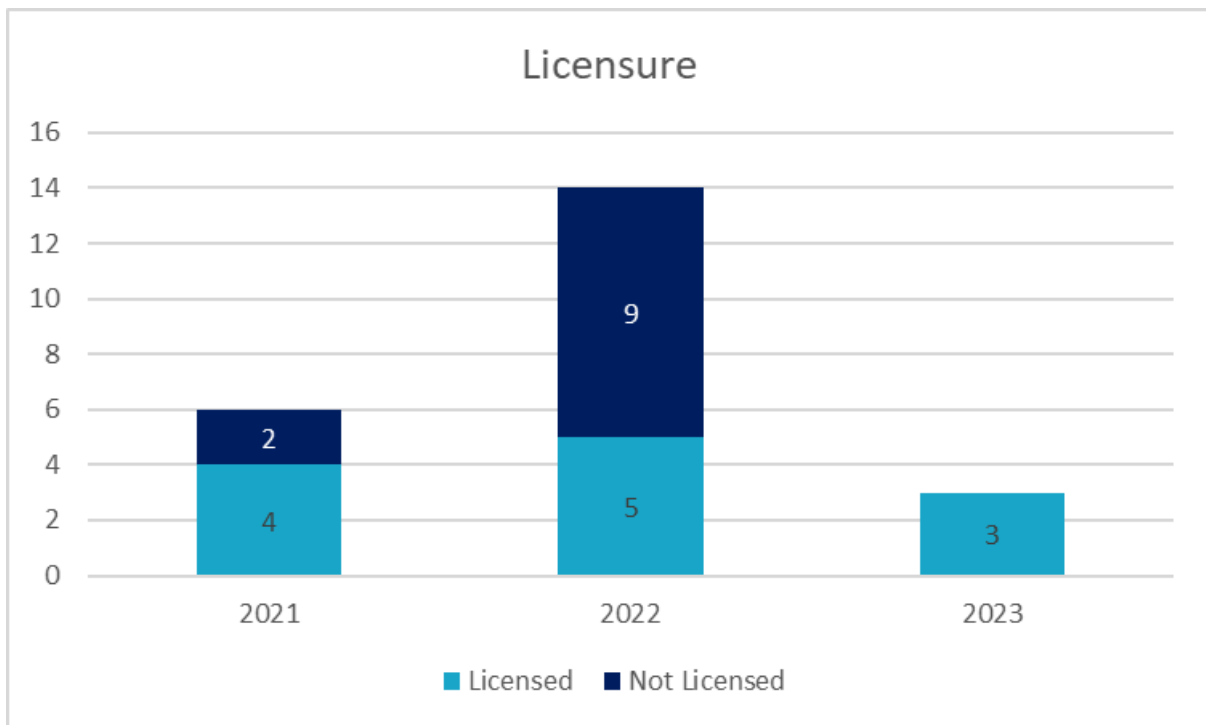
Standard 3 Performance Level

MEETS

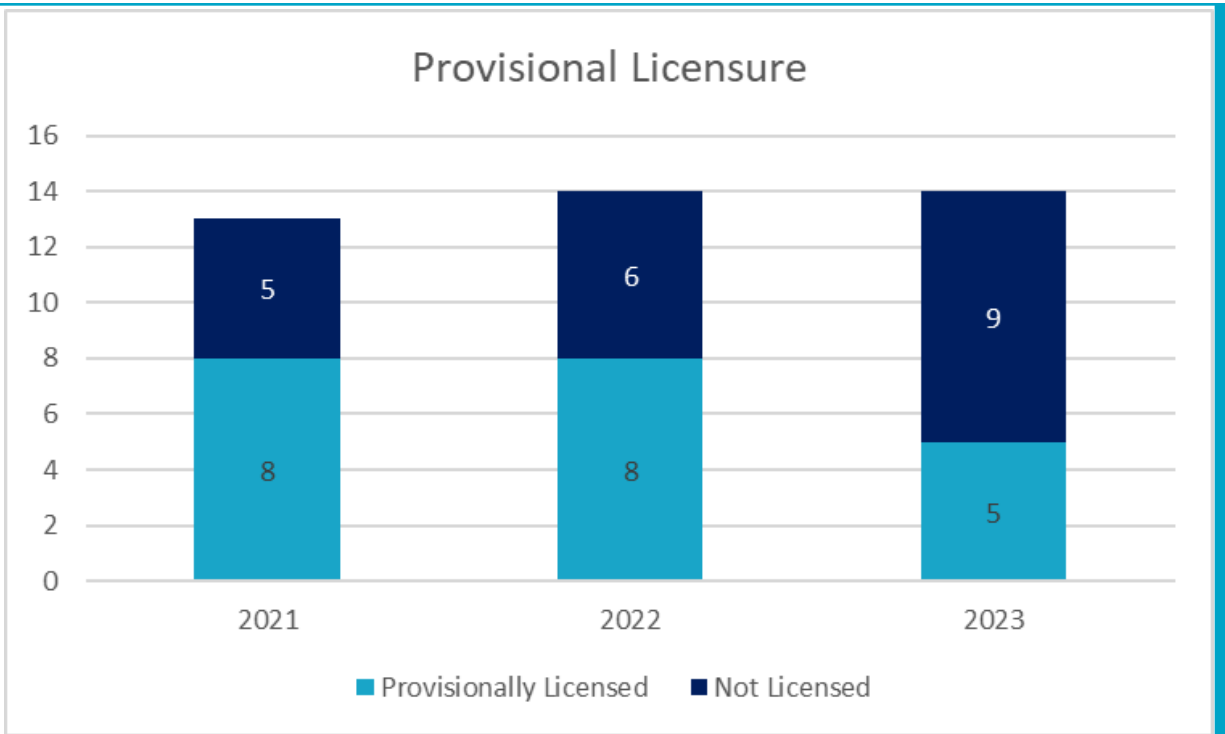
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
BELOW	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that alternative program enrollees who are employed obtain provisional licensure and are prepared to obtain standard licensure immediately following completion. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1a and 3.1b)</i> - Ensure that program completers have the capacity to impact student growth and can demonstrate that capacity in the classroom. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3c)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	80%	52%	BELOW



Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	51%	BELOW

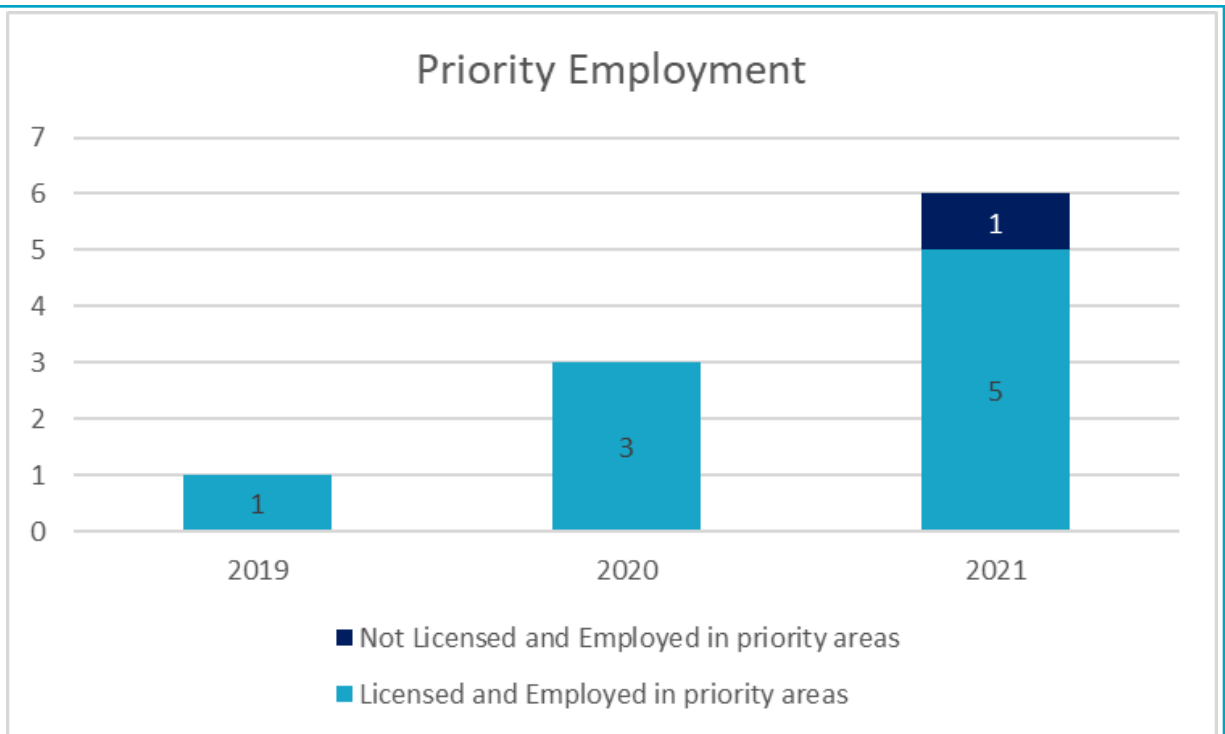


Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	NA	NA

INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	100%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>1</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>3</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>6</td><td>0</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed	2019	1	0	2020	3	0	2021	6	0
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed													
2019	1	0													
2020	3	0													
2021	6	0													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	90%	EXCEEDS												



*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

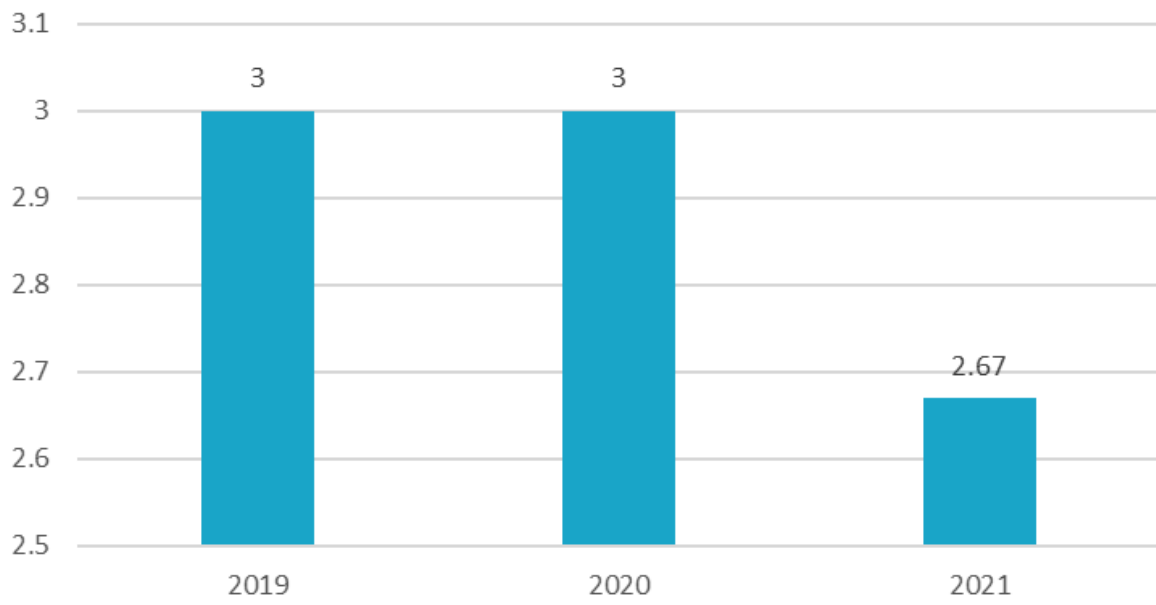
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	2.8	EXCEEDS

Average Experience 3 Years After Completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	100%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	83%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	33%	APPROACHING

